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G21 — False Friends & Confusing Words

Les faux amis et mots confusants

 July 17 S3-S4	 B1-B2	 marc.vasseur@polytech-lille.fr
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 Un faux ami est un mot anglais qui ressemble à un mot français mais a un sens différent. Ces erreurs sont très fréquentes et peuvent créer des malentendus professionnels graves.

1. Faux amis essentiels — contexte académique et professionnel

MOT ANGLAIS	SENS RÉEL EN ANGLAIS	≠ FAUX AMI FRANÇAIS	TRADUCTION CORRECTE du concept FR
actually	en fait, en réalité	≠ actuellement	currently, at present, nowadays
eventually	finalemt (après un moment)	≠ éventuellement (peut-être)	possibly, perhaps, if needed
library	bibliothèque	≠ librairie	bookshop, bookstore
sympathetic	compréhensif, compatissant	≠ sympathique (nice)	nice, friendly, likeable, pleasant
sensible	raisonnable, sensé	≠ sensible (toucher)	sensitive (to touch/feeling)
confident	sûr de soi	≠ confidentiel	confidential, classified
pretend	faire semblant	≠ prétendre (affirmer)	claim, maintain, assert
achieve	accomplir, réussir	≠ achever (finir)	complete, finish, finalise
demand	exiger (fort)	≠ demander (ask, request)	ask, request, enquire
assist	aider, assister	≠ assister à (attend)	attend, be present at
proper	convenable, approprié	≠ propre (clean)	clean, tidy, neat
large	grand (taille)	≠ large (largeur)	wide, broad
deceive	tromper, duper	≠ décevoir (disappoint)	disappoint, let down
chance	occasion, probabilité	≠ chance (luck)	luck, good fortune
resume	CV (AmE) / reprendre	≠ résumé (summary)	summary, abstract, overview

2. Paires confusantes

PAIRE	DIFFÉRENCE CLÉE
affect (v.) / effect (n.)	Climate change affects biodiversity. / The effect is measurable.
principal (adj.) / principle (n.)	The principal engineer. / The principle of conservation.
complement (v.) / compliment (v./n.)	This data complements the study. / She complimented his work.
stationary (adj.) / stationery (n.)	The car was stationary. / Office stationery (paper, pens...).
practice (n.) / practise (v. UK)	Good practice. / Practise every day.
advice (n.) / advise (v.)	She gave me advice. / She advised me to apply.
economic (adj.) / economical (adj.)	An economic crisis. / An economical solution (cost-effective).
historic (adj.) / historical (adj.)	A historic moment (significant). / A historical study (past).

 **Quand tu vois un mot anglais qui ressemble au français → méfie-toi! Vérifie dans le dictionnaire. Règle d'or : 'actually' ≠ 'actuellement' / 'eventually' ≠ 'éventuellement'.**

EXERCICES GUIDÉS

Choisis le mot correct ou corrige l'erreur.

Série guidée A — Faux amis en contexte

 Lis la définition entre parenthèses pour identifier le bon mot anglais

- She is very _____ (= raisonnable, sensée) about risk management.
→ sensible ≠ sensitive
→ _____
- He _____ (= exige) an immediate and full response from the team.
→ to demand ≠ to ask
→ _____
- The drug was _____ (= finalement) approved after five years of clinical trials.
→ eventually ≠ éventuellement
→ _____
- The misleading graph _____ (= a trompé) all the reviewers.
→ deceived ≠ disappointed
→ _____
- She _____ (= fait semblant de) not to hear the critical feedback.
→ pretends ≠ claims
→ _____
- He went to the _____ (= bibliothèque) to find academic papers.
→ library ≠ bookshop
→ _____

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7. I _____ (= ai assisté à) the entire conference last week.

→ attended ≠ assisted

→ _____

8. The office needs to be _____ (= propre, rangé) before the inspection.

→ clean/tidy ≠ proper

→ _____

9. She _____ (= a prétendu, affirmé) she had no prior knowledge of the error.

→ claimed ≠ pretended

→ _____

10. _____ (= En fait), the experiment produced the opposite result.

→ Actually ≠ Currently

→ _____

Série guidée B — Paires confusantes

💡 affect (verbe) / effect (nom) / principal (adj) / principle (nom)

11. This policy decision will _____ (affect/effect) all departments.

→ verbe → affect

→ _____

12. The _____ (affect/effect) of the new regulation was immediate.

→ nom → effect

→ _____

13. The _____ (principal/principle) goal of the project is emissions reduction.

→ main (adj) → principal

→ _____

14. This methodology is based on the _____ (principal/principle) of parsimony.

→ rule → principle

→ _____

15. The experimental data _____ (complements/compliments) our initial hypothesis.

→ to complete → complements

→ _____

16. She _____ (complimented/complemented) him on his excellent oral presentation.

→ to praise → complimented

→ _____

17. This is an _____ (economic/economical) approach — it uses very few resources.

→ cost-effective → economical

→ _____

18. The _____ (economic/economical) consequences of the decision were serious.

→ relating to the economy → economic

→ _____

19. She gave me some excellent _____ (advice/advise) on the application process.

→ nom → advice

→ _____

20. He _____ (advised/advise) me to apply for the research fellowship.

→ verbe → advised

→ _____



EXERCICES — NIVEAUX A → B2+

Corrige l'erreur ou choisis le bon mot.

Niveau A — Faux amis classiques (B1)

1. She is very sensible about cold temperatures. (ERREUR) → _____
→ _____
2. He eventually asked me for help. → (Si l'intention est 'éventuellement') → _____
→ _____
3. The library is a great place to buy new textbooks. (ERREUR) → _____
→ _____
4. I assisted the international conference last Tuesday. (ERREUR) → _____
→ _____
5. He claimed / pretended to understand everything. → Lequel si 'il fait semblant de'? → _____
→ _____

Niveau B — Paires confusantes en contexte (B1+)

6. Choose: The increased pollution _____ (affects/effects) marine biodiversity.
→ _____
7. Choose: The _____ (affect/effect) on local wildlife has been devastating.
→ _____
8. Choose: Our _____ (principal/principle) aim is to reduce operational costs.
→ _____
9. Choose: This decision violates a basic _____ (principal/principle) of engineering ethics.
→ _____
10. Choose: She _____ (complimented/complemented) him on his excellent analytical work.
→ _____

→ Corrige si nécessaire.

11. She is very sympathetic with her struggling students. → _____
→ _____
12. He demanded me to explain the results. → _____
→ _____
13. I'm going to the library to buy a new reference book. → _____
→ _____
14. Actually, the meeting hasn't started yet — we're still waiting. → _____
→ _____
15. This is a proper (= propre, rangé) office — very tidy. → _____
→ _____

Niveau C — Traduction (B1+–B2)

→ Traduis ces phrases délicates en évitant les faux amis.

16. En fait, les résultats sont bien meilleurs que prévu.
→ _____
17. Elle a finalement obtenu le financement après deux ans de démarches.
→ _____
18. Il est très sympathique avec ses étudiants.

→ _____

19. Cette approche est raisonnable et facile à mettre en œuvre.

→ _____

20. La décision a trompé de nombreux investisseurs.

→ _____

→ Traduis ces phrases délicates en évitant les faux amis.

21. Je suis allé à la bibliothèque pour trouver des articles sur ce sujet.

→ _____

22. Il a exigé une réponse immédiate de tous les membres de l'équipe.

→ _____

23. Elle a prétendu ne pas connaître les résultats.

→ _____

24. La décision a déçu de nombreux chercheurs.

→ _____

25. Actuellement, le laboratoire manque de ressources suffisantes.

→ _____

Niveau D — Production et vigilance (B2+)

→ Identifie et corrige tous les faux amis dans ce texte.

26. Actually, our team arrived at the conference and assisted it with great interest. The principal speakers were very sympathetic and sensible about the concerns raised. Eventually, if needed, we may publish our findings. We demand the reviewers to take these results seriously.

→ _____

Score : _____ / 26 points

★ ★ Bonus — Faux amis moins connus

Donne le sens réel de ces mots anglais et leur faux ami français.

→ comprehensive (adj.) → sens réel? ≠ ?

Réponse : _____

→ affluent (adj.) → sens réel? ≠ ?

Réponse : _____

→ genial (adj.) → sens réel? ≠ ?

Réponse : _____

→ benevolent (adj.) → sens réel? ≠ ?

Réponse : _____

→ candid (adj.) → sens réel? ≠ ?

Réponse : _____



DEVOIR MAISON

Nom & Prénom : _____

Groupe : _____

Date rendu : _____



Choisis le bon mot ou traduis correctement.



Correction envoyée via WhatsApp la semaine prochaine.

1. She is very _____ (= compréhensive, compatissante) with her struggling students.
→ _____
2. The experiment _____ (affect/effect) the results significantly.
→ _____
3. He went to the _____ (= bibliothèque) to find research papers on thermodynamics.
→ _____
4. The CEO _____ (= a exigé) a full written report by end of day.
→ _____
5. She _____ (= fait semblant de) not to understand the question.
→ _____
6. The _____ (principal/principle) aim is to reduce carbon emissions by 40%.
→ _____
7. She _____ (deceived/disappointed) us with her below-average results.
→ _____
8. The new laboratory _____ (complements/compliments) the existing research infrastructure.
→ _____
9. He is very _____ (= raisonnable, sensé) about project risk management.
→ _____
10. The treatment was _____ (= finalement) approved after an extended review process.
→ _____
11. She _____ (= a assisté à) the full international symposium last month.
→ _____
12. This is a very _____ (economic/economical) solution — it saves both time and money.
→ _____
13. The decision had serious _____ (economic/economical) consequences for the region.
→ _____
14. He _____ (advised/advice) her to apply for the competitive research grant.
→ _____
15. _____ (= En fait), the system was already working — no action was needed.
→ _____

Score : _____ / 15 points